



Gameplay

In the game of Algomancy, you are an Algomancer vying for control over an AI simulated world. By manipulating source code with your Algomantic powers, you are able to summon armies, cast spells, and modify game objects to expand their capabilities or infect viruses onto the opposition.

How to Win

In order to win a game of Algomancy, you must eliminate all of your opponents by reducing their life total to zero. In team games, you must eliminate the entire opposing team.

Flexible Game Options

Algomancy is an incredibly flexible game with a variety of game options. You can pair any of the game modes with any of the player configurations. For the first game we recommend 1v1 or free for all. A brief summary of these is given below:

Game Modes

- Live Draft (Standard Algomancy): Players share one deck and draft cards from it during the game.
- Pre-Draft: You draft a complete deck of a minimum 30 cards before the game begins, and play games of constructed with it.
- Constructed: You build a deck with a minimum size of 30 cards and a maximum of 2 copies of each card ahead of time and bring that to your games.
- Team draft: Your team builds a large deck of 100 cards and a maximum of 2 copies of each card ahead of time and your team drafts from that deck during the game.

Player Configurations

- 1v1: A heads up game between two players that uses the initiative system for more of a competitive aspect.
- 3v3: The standard team structure for algomancy. Teams of 3 battle it out to see which can come out on top.
- Free For All: A fun and casual experience for 2 to 9 players (and expandible to infinite players if more copies of the game are available).
- 2v1: An archenemy style game where one player with bonus cards and resources faces off against two weaker opponents.

Quick Start Guide

The best way to learn Algomancy is by playing it. This rulebook is designed to guide you through the basic concepts of the game as you would encounter them in a first playthrough, so we recommend setting up a game and learning as you go. To get started:

- Select which factions you wish to play with (For a first game, we suggest Fire and Wood). If you are not experienced, remove all of the rare cards from the decks (gold set symbol). Shuffle the cards from the chosen factions together. This is the deck.



Wood and Fire cards



All cards in the deck have this cardback.

- Place all of the resources and tokens in a convenient location where you can access them during the game.

- Randomly determine a player to have the initiative.
- Set life totals to 30.
- Deal 16 cards and 2 Mana converters to each player.
- Begin the game!



Assign at random



x16 in hand



x2 in play

Anatomy of an Algomancy Card

Cards

Algomancy cards each have the following characteristics:

- All cards have a name (1).
- A mana cost (2) that must be paid in order to be played.
- Threshold (3) denotes how much affinity is required to play a card.
- Some cards will have special timing icons (4), which modify when and how you can play them.
- Stats (5) which denote power and health, respectively.
- Attributes (6) describe the qualities of the card, including some combat abilities, denoted in bold.
- Most cards have Abilities (7), which describe the card's effects.
- They also have a set symbol (8) which indicates the expansion and its color denotes the complexity of the card.

Units

Units are permanents, meaning when summoned, they will stay in play until removed. They can be easily recognized by the existence of stats on the card (5).



Spells

Generally, spells provide temporary effects and are used to interact with other players. When a spell resolves, it goes directly to your discard.

The most important aspect of a spell to pay attention to is the timing indicator (4), which lets you know if the spell can be used during combat or not.

Timing

- Cards with no icon (9) can only be played during the main phase.
- Cards with the haste icon (10) can be played during the mana step and the main phase.
- Cards with the battle icon (11) can only be played when in combat with another player (**and not during the main phase!**)
- The virus icon (4) allows you to augment cards from hand during combat (for more information, see **Augment**).

There are also spell units, which have a one time effect like spells but also have stats (5) and enter play rather than the discard as they resolve.

Resources

Resources are the essential source of mana in Algomancy and are required in order to play your cards. They have the following characteristics:

- They have an affinity (1), which allows you to meet the threshold requirements on cards.
- Attributes (2) which tell you the type of resource it is.
- Abilities (3) that describe any special effects of the resource.
- A set symbol (4), which tells you which expansion of the game they came from.

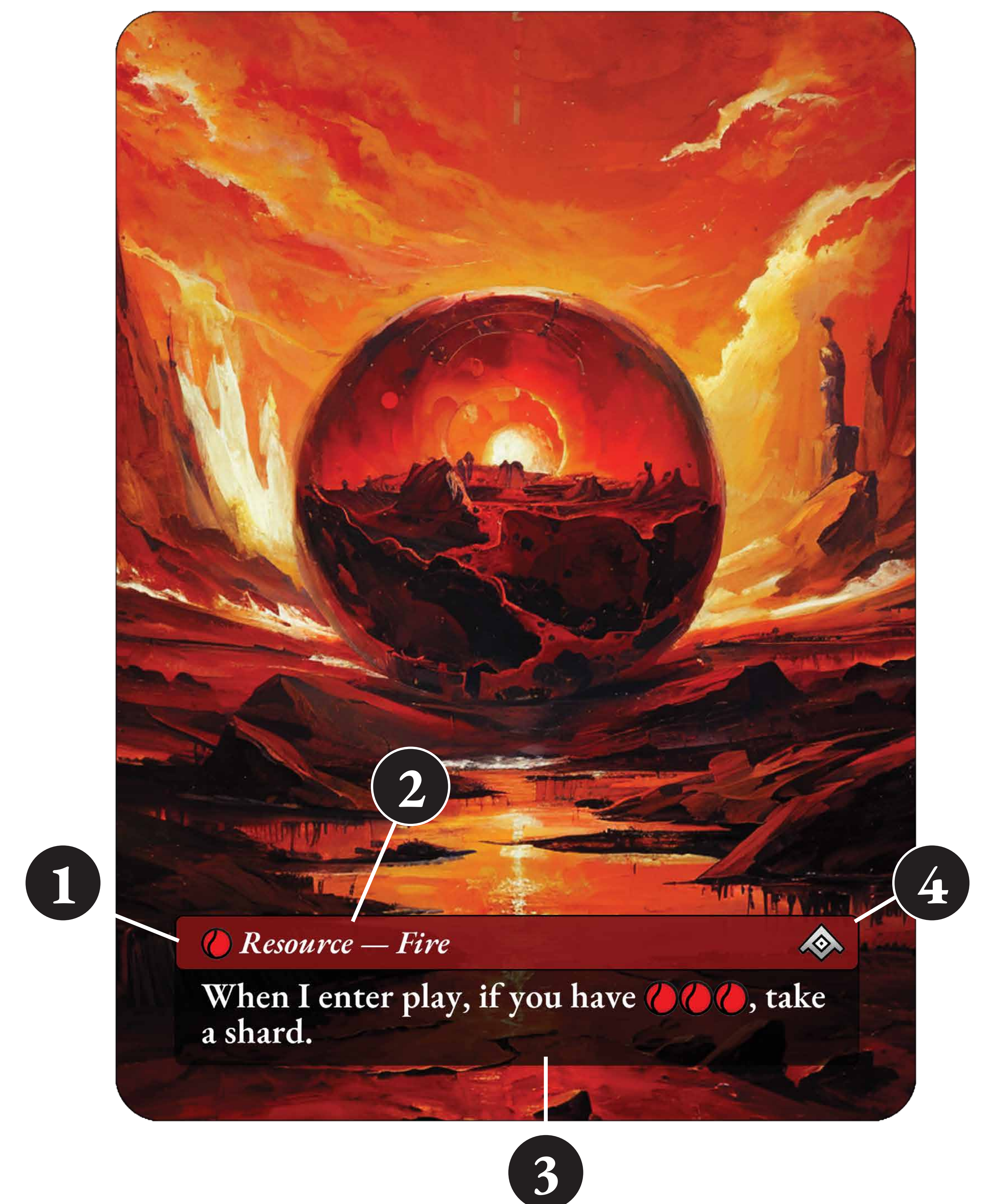
All resources have the ability to be expended (turned sideways) for 1 mana once per turn. This is how you pay for the mana cost of cards and abilities.



Spell Tokens

When you create a spell token, it is put directly into play in the region it was created in. Spell tokens are unique as they are the only cards currently that are “cast” from play, which functions the same way as if they were cast from your hand, but you may only cast spell tokens in the region the token is in. To get around this, spell tokens can be brought into other regions during the attack step if they have units to guide them. This move is irreversible though, so plan carefully where you want to direct your resources!

The magic captured in a spell token is limited, and any remaining spell tokens are erased from the game during re-group, so be sure to use them before they go away!



Tokens

Tokens are temporary cards that are created directly into play during the game. If they leave play or enter a zone such as a hand or discard, they are erased from the game and returned to the token pile.

In addition to the standard card attributes, tokens have the following unique characteristics:

- While tokens do have a mana cost (5), it often 0, meaning you can play the cards “for free”. This specifically applies to spell tokens (see below).
- Spell tokens have an attribute, **Burst (6)**, which requires you to cast all of your tokens with the same name at the same time. They are still unique spells, but they are cast together.
- Many tokens have an X value (7), which is determined by the card that created them. For example “Create a Crystal 3” would set the X value of the created token as 3.

The Turn

Turns in Algomancy are global, meaning all players share the same phases, and sync up at the end of each step. This process will look slightly different depending on wheither you are playing a free for all or team based game (1v1 counts as a team game). The simplest structure to understand is free for all, where each phase is truly shared by all players at once and intent tokens are used to declare simultaneous attacks.

Initiative

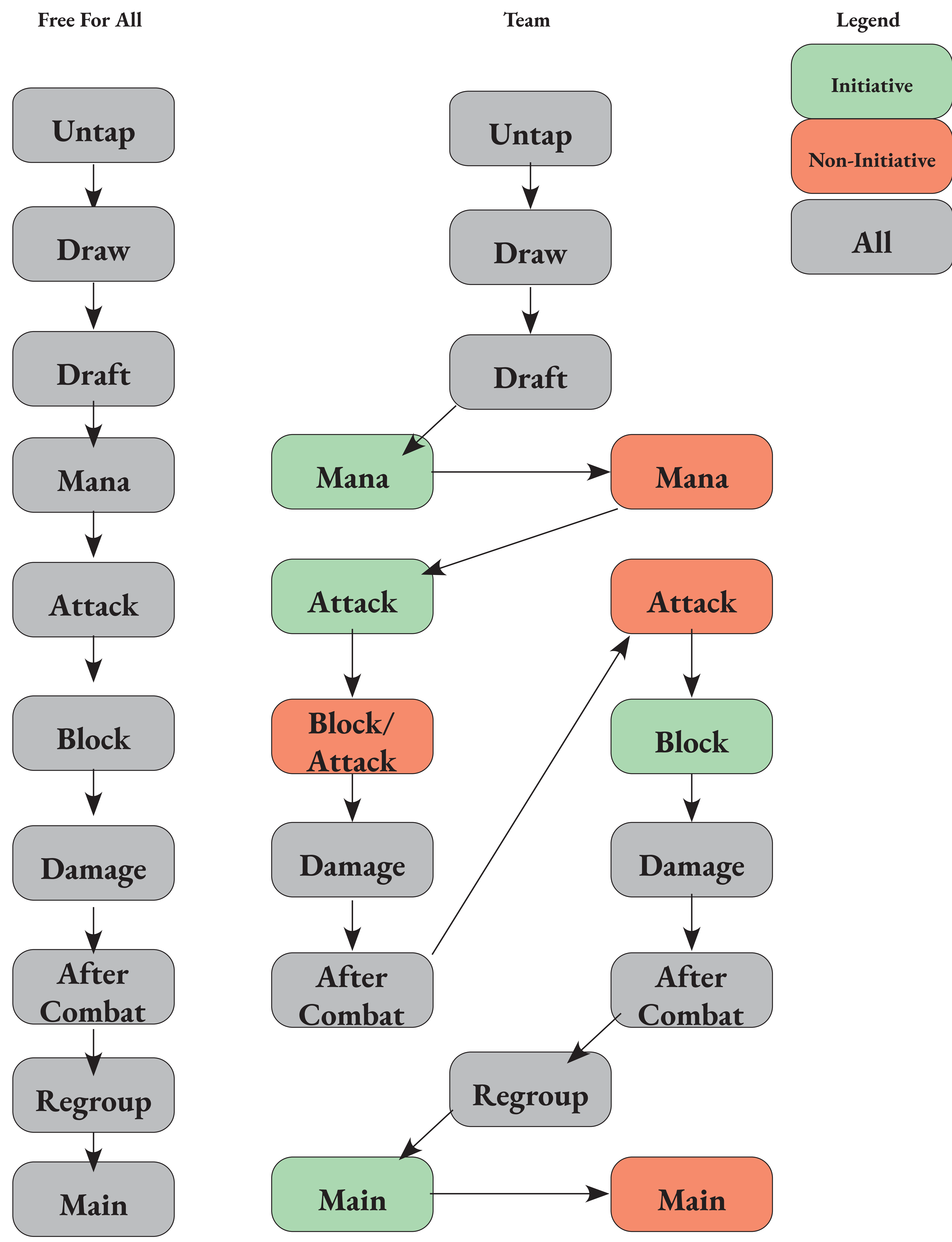
Team games utilize an initiative system, where teams trade off having the initiative every turn cycle. When a team has the initiative, they act together and are required to act first in all situations. For example, during the mana and main phases, the initiative team must make all of their plays first while the non-initiative gets to wait and see what they do before taking their actions.

Because of this, the initiative combat step happens in two phases:

- First, the initiative team declares their attacks, sending units into non-initiative regions. After a priority window for interaction, the non initiative team declare their blocking formations while also having the opportunity to send attacking units for a counterattack. The counter attacking units leave the region at this time, but their attack step takes place after the first combat has completely finished. After the block/counter attack step, combat in the non-initiative regions resolves as normal, with a damage step and an after combat step.
- Second, the counterattacking units are put into formation and the entire combat sequence takes place again with the non-initiative attackers. Each team only gets one chance to attack, so there are no additional counter attacks here.

Ending a Turn

After the main phase, the turn is over. The initiative and any draft packs are passed to the next player in a clockwise direction and the entire process is repeated again.



Draw and Draft Steps

Draw

Players draw 2 cards during the draw step on every turn after the first.

Drafting

Drafting is the process of selecting cards from “Packs” of cards. The main algomancy format uses a live draft throughout the game as the source of cards. This all takes place during the draft step.

Packs

At the start of a game or when the draft is refreshed (see below), each player is dealt a Pack of cards. Packs in Algomancy always have 10 cards in them when they are dealt or passed to other players. Packs may only be interacted with and looked at during the draft step, and players may not look at the packs of other players. When a player is eliminated, their pack is recycled (put on the bottom of the deck in a random order).

Complete Flexibility

During the draft step, players combine all of the non-token, non-resource cards in their hand with the pack and can draft a completely new hand of cards. The only limitation is that they must pass a full pack of 10 cards at the end of the drafting step. Effectively this means you should end up with as many cards as you started with in hand. So if you begin a draft step with 4 cards in hand, you will end the draft step with 4 cards in hand. But if you are unsure or lose track of how many cards you had, you just need to make sure you are leaving 10 cards in the pack when you pass it.

This means you have complete flexibility and control of what cards you want during the drafting process. If you like your seven card hand, you can just keep all seven of those cards and take nothing new. If you dislike your hand, you can completely exchange your entire hand for a completely new set of cards, or anything in-between!

Passing the Pack

Once you have finished a draft portion, you will pass your pack clockwise to the next player as an indicator that you are finished. Once all players have passed their packs, the draft step is complete.

Refreshing the packs

After $N+1$ turns, where N is the number of players, all of the packs are recycled (put on the bottom of the deck in a random order) and each player is dealt a new pack of cards. For 1v1, this happens after the third turn, right before the fourth draft.

Team Draft

For team draft, a team of players will bring a pre-constructed deck of cards that the entire team will draft from. Rather than passing their packs clockwise to the nearest player when finished, they pass it to the nearest teammate. Additionally, packs are never refreshed in team drafts. All the other draft rules apply.

Constructed

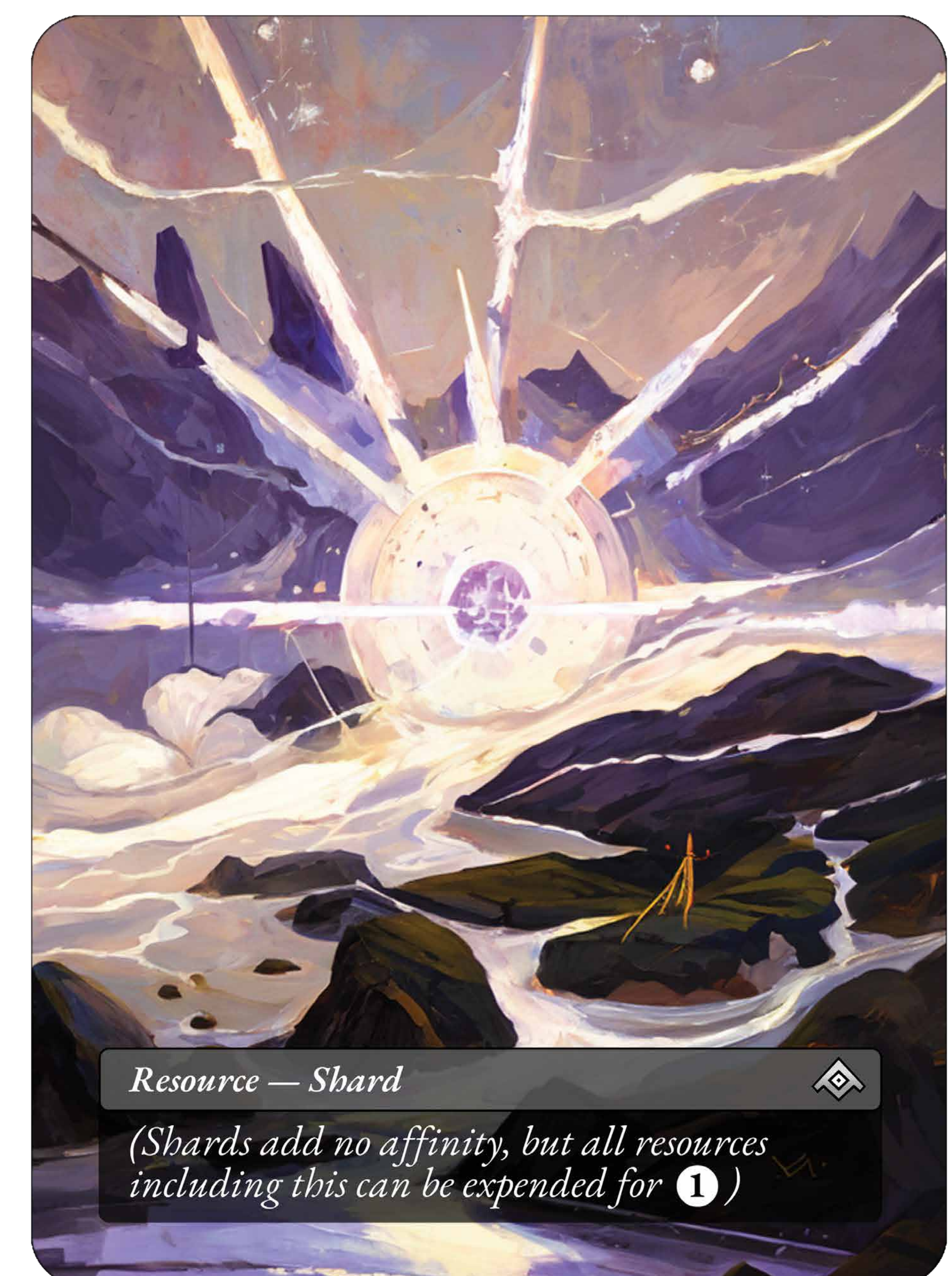
In constructed, there is no deck to draft from, so the draft step and the draw step are combined into one draw phase. During the draw phase in constructed, players draw 4 cards, then select 2 cards from their hand and put them on the bottom of the deck in any order. This mimics the flexibility of the draft step while keeping the essence of a constructed format.

The Mana Step

Resources

The mana step is when players have the ability to take and play resources, as well as play cards with Haste timing. During this step, most resources are freely available and can be picked up from outside the game by recycling a card in your hand (putting it on the bottom of the deck). There is no player interaction during this step.

Players may play a maximum of two resources per turn, but are not limited in how many resources they can take during the mana step. Additionally, each player begins the game with two Mana Converters in play, which count as their two resources for the turn. They may be exchanged with other resources if desired or held onto for later.



Shards and Affinity Bonuses

All of the basic elemental resources have the ability “When I enter play, if you have at least three of my affinity, take a shard”. Shards are a resource that adds no affinity, but can still be expended for mana. This rewards you for sticking to one color by giving you additional mana! As an example above, when the third water is played, a shard can be put into hand for free (and played immediately). Any future waters that are played will also provide this benefit.

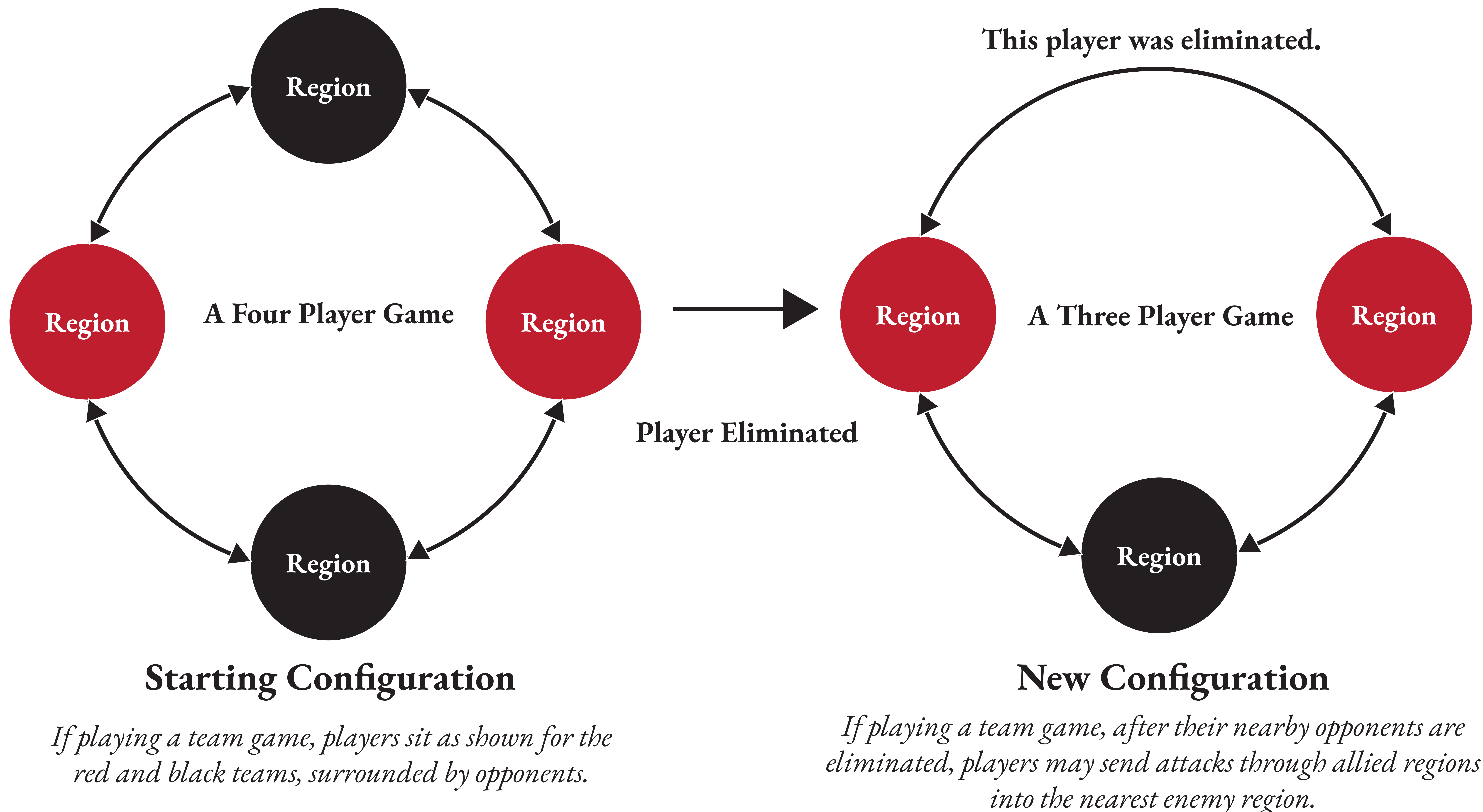
Regions and Local Effects

Regions

All gameplay in Algomancy takes place inside of “Regions”. Each region is completely self-contained and isolated from all other regions, meaning **nothing that happens inside of one region will affect anything in another region**. This is perhaps the single most important rule of Algomancy: Every single effect is specific to its region. “Destroy all units” means “Destroy all units in this region” because as far as the effect is concerned, the units in the region are all the units that exist. “Each player takes 1 damage” means “Each player in this region takes 1 damage” for the same reason. An effect that says “Delete target unit” really means “Delete target unit in this region” because it cannot see the units in other regions. **The only exception to this rule is with the attack step, where players can enter neighboring regions by sending units over to battle.**

Each player exists in their own unique region. This means that outside of the combat phase, there is absolutely no player interaction because there are no opponents to interact with. The player regions are arranged in a large circle, so each player has two neighboring regions, except in the case of 1v1, where there is only one neighboring region. For team games, each player should start with an opponent on either side of them.

When a player is eliminated, their adjacent regions become connected and the game continues. **If playing a team game, after their nearby opponents are eliminated, players may send attacks through allied regions into the nearest enemy region.**



Attacking

In order to interact with other players, you'll need to enter their region or have them enter yours. This takes place during the attack step as the beginning of the combat portion of a turn. During this step, you select a set of units and other cards such as spell tokens that you wish to bring with you into a new region. Then you simply declare them as attackers by bringing them into that region. By doing so, you and your units that you attacked with are now in the new region, and can be interacted with as such.

Attacking in Free For All

In a free for all game, all players declare their attacks simultaneously using the “Intent” cards. Simply place an intent card face down in front of each of your units and other cards such as spell tokens with your intended action. Once all players have finished this, all of the cards are flipped up and the chosen attacks take place instantly!

There is a lot of freedom in how you can do this, so feel free to get creative. You can group units together behind one intent card or even place multiple intent cards of the same type on different units in an attempt to hide your intentions!



Attacking in Teams

Team games utilize an initiative system where teams trade off having to act first. We say the team designated to act first each turn has the initiative. The attack process in this game mode is broken into multiple steps.

- First, the team with initiative declares all of their attacks at once.
- Then, after a priority window where players can interact, the defending team gets the opportunity for a counter-attack while they also declare their defending formations (more information on formations later).
- Combat is first resolved completely in the regions that were initially attacked by the initiative team.
- Then, combat in the counter-attacking regions is resolved.

A short way to remember it is that combat in team games has an attack -> counter attack flow to it, in contrast to the single global attack step in free for all games.

Combat

1 2

Units and Stats

Units are the basis of combat, as they are used to attack opponents, enter new regions and defend yourself against invaders. Each unit has a set of stats (1,2) that indicate their utility in combat. The two numbers represent the Power (1) and Health (2) of the unit, respectively. Power indicates how much damage the unit will do in combat, and health is a measure of how much damage a unit can take before it dies.

Combat Formations

When units attack or block, they are placed in a “Formation” just like soldiers lining up for battle. Formations can be infinitely large in width, but only a maximum of two units deep, as there is a front and back row. Attacking formations are set during the attack step and defensive formations are set during the block step. Once a formation is set, the units are locked in position and are considered Adjacent to their left, right, front and back neighbors until regroup.

Unlimited Columns



Hold the Line

Like in real combat, in Algomancy it is imperative to maintain a solid front-line of combat. This is upheld by the following rules:

- The front row of a column must be filled first before a unit can be placed in a back row.
- If a unit is removed from a formation, any units behind it move to the front row and take its place.
- If the last unit in a column is removed from an attacking formation before blocks, the columns to its left and right close in to fill the gap.

Max of 2 rows

Blocking

When a player is attacked by a formation, they get an opportunity to defend during the block step. To do so, they may place units in front of the formation that is attacking them. The resulting group of defending units is also called a Formation, but unlike offensive formations, the defending formation can have some missing columns.

Blocked

Once a defensive unit has been placed in front of an attacking column, that entire column is considered “Blocked”. Blocked units won’t deal combat damage to you, even if the units blocking them are removed!

Damage

After all of the blocks have been declared and both players have passed priority, we move to the damage step. During the damage step, all of the follwing damage processes happen simultaneously, unless modified by an ability.

Each column of attacking units in a formation deals damage equal to the combined power of each unit within that column.

Unblocked attacking damage is dealt to the defending player’s life total, blocked attacking damage is dealt to the defending column.

Similarly, each column of defending units deals damage equal to the combined power of each unit within its column to the attacking column it has blocked.

When a column of units takes combat damage, they recieve damage from front to back. First, the front row recieves damage.

If the amount of damage recieved would be enough to kill the front row, any excess damage is dealt to the unit in the back row. Excess damage beyond the health of the back row unit does not carry over to the player, unless the damage comes from a unit with the Piercing attribute.

All damage on units goes away during the regroup step.

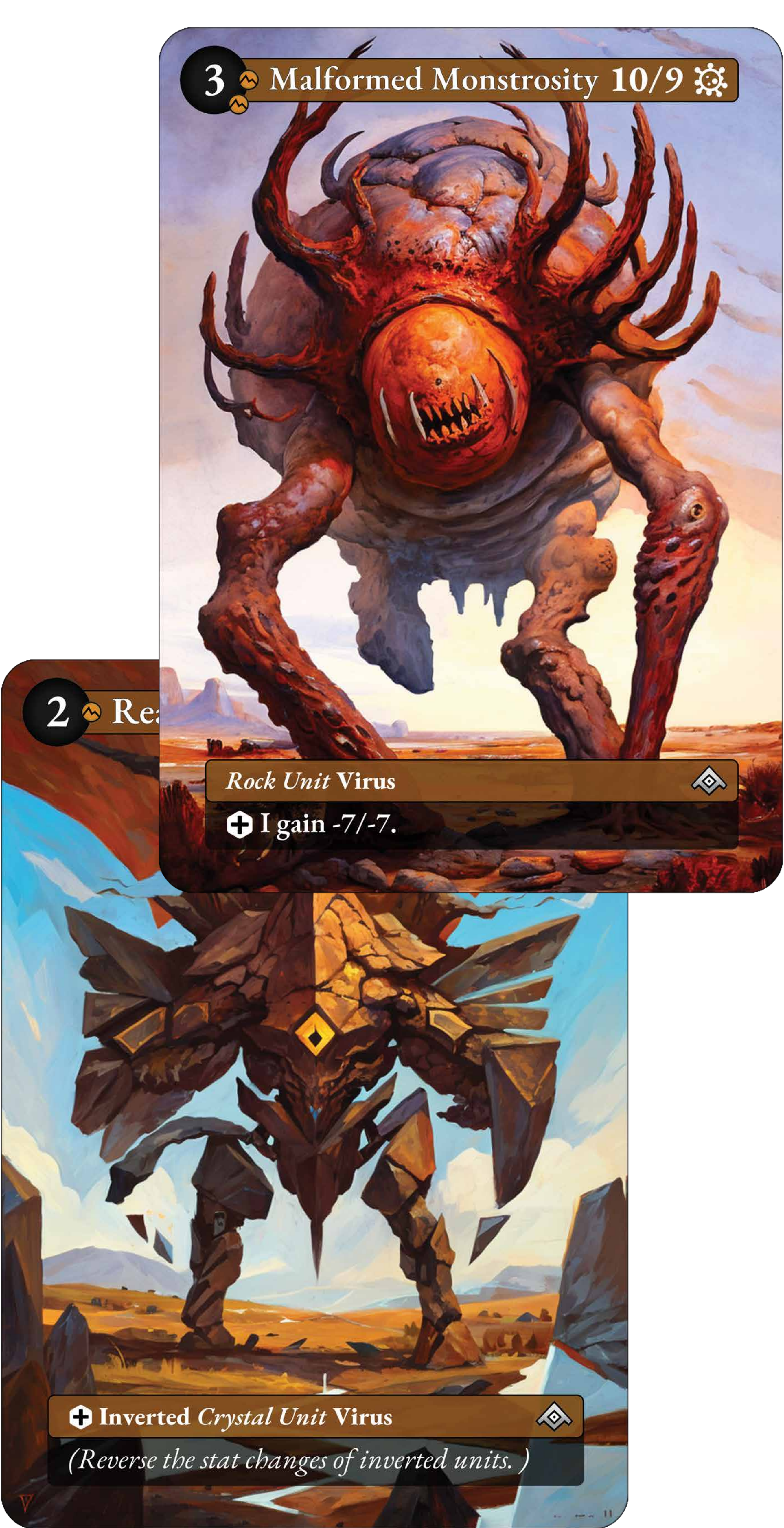
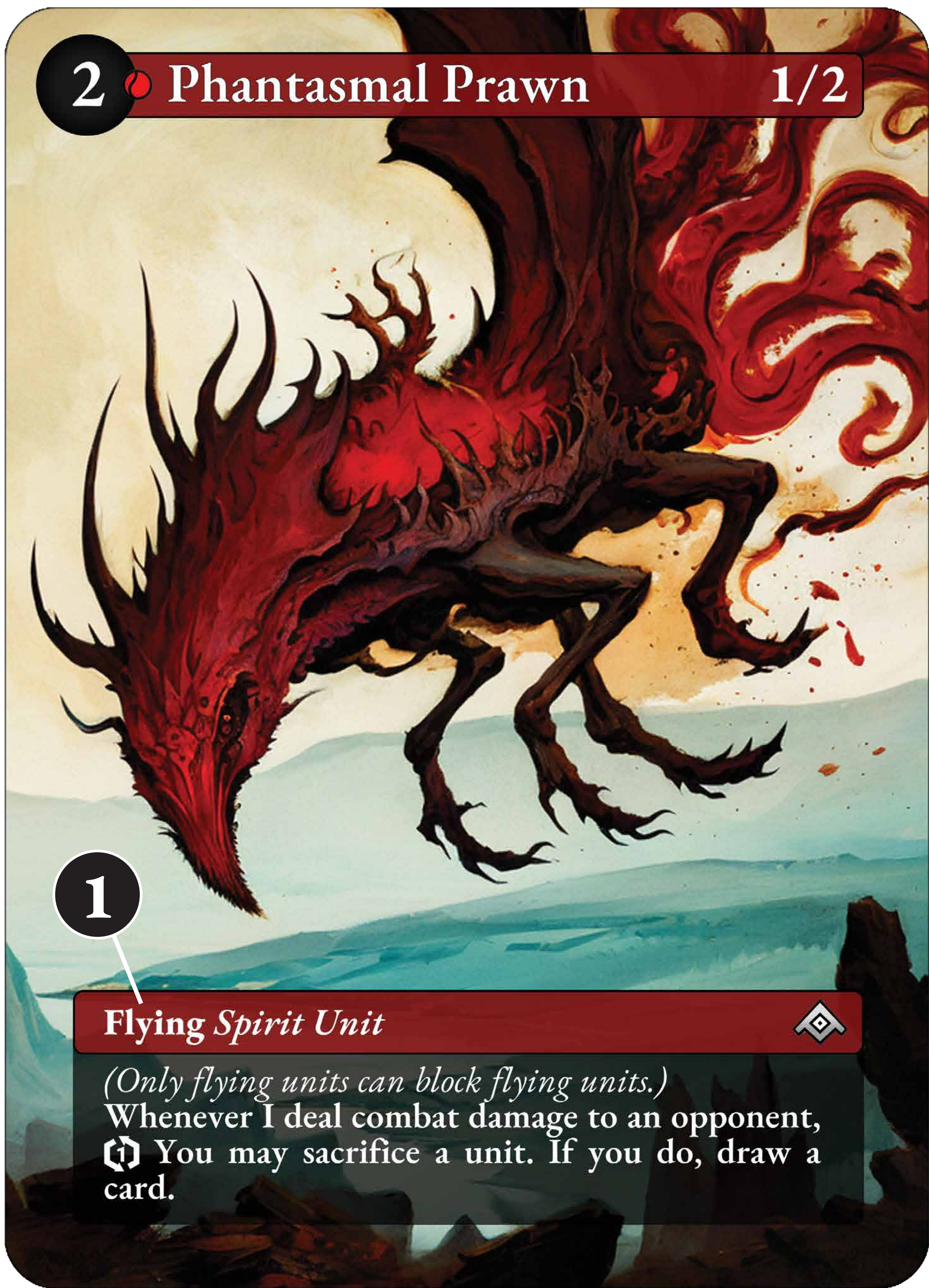


Attributes

In addition to stats, some units have Attributes (1), which can change how they engage in combat. All of the units with attributes have a reminder text in italics to help you remember what each attribute does. Smoke Ghost here has the Flying attribute, which says “Only flying units can block flying units.”

Units in the same column of a formation share attributes, meaning that if Smoke Ghost attacks with another unit in front or behind it, both of those units have the Flying attribute and the entire column cannot be blocked unless the defending player also has flying units. Note that this only applies to columns. If Smoke ghost attacks to the left or the right of another unit, it will not gain Flying.

But be careful! If a unit with attributes is removed, all other units in its column will immediately lose access to any attributes it had been sharing. This means if you attack with Smoke Ghost and a plain 1/1 token, if the opponent kills the Smoke Ghost before combat, they can block the token without flying units because the token would no longer have flying!



Attribute Combos

This ability to share attributes is an incredibly powerful aspect of Algomancy, so keep your eyes open for any powerful combos that this may unlock!

For example, if we attack with Malformed Monstrosity in a column with Reality Bender, Malformed Monstrosity would gain the “Inverted” attribute, which reverses its stat changes. Because the Monstrosity has an ability that gives it -7/-7, it becomes inverted to +7/+7, turning it into a 17/16!

Similarly, Spike has the “Ranged” attribute, which allows it to deal combat damage first and block fliers. If we pair it with Big Eye, who has the “Deadly” attribute, we can instantly kill anything before it has a chance to fight back!

Priority and Player Interaction

Priority

The term priority denotes the ability of a player to perform game actions such as casting spells or activating abilities. A player with priority has the ability to do these things, while players without priority do not. In team games, all players on a team share priority and can take actions in whichever order they choose amongst themselves.

Priority Window

A priority window is a sequence where players or teams each receive priority in order. In Algomancy, the attack, block, damage and after combat steps all have a priority window, giving the players the opportunity to interact with each other. The resolution of an effect, such as a spell or ability also creates a priority window.

Within a priority window, first the initiative player will receive priority. Then if they decline to do anything, priority will be passed clockwise to the next non-initiative player in the region. This process is repeated until all players or teams have passed priority.

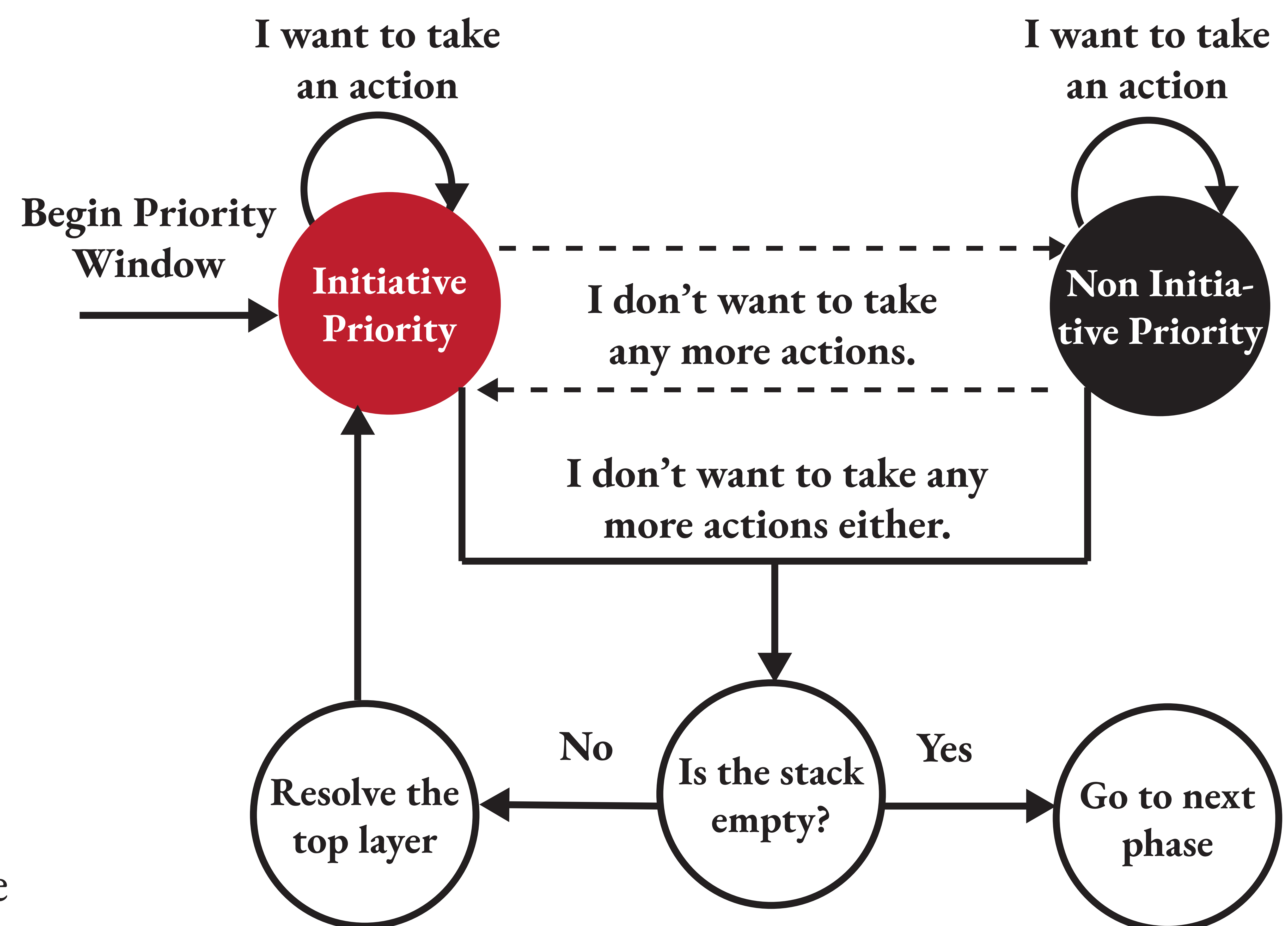
Interaction

If a player does use their priority to take game actions, they may maintain their priority to continue taking game actions. Once they pass priority after taking an action, each other player will receive priority again to get a chance to respond to their action. This process continues until all players pass priority.

Example

In a 1v1 game Player A has the initiative and attacks player B. There is a priority window during the attack step, so player A receives priority first. They can play spells or activate abilities at this time.

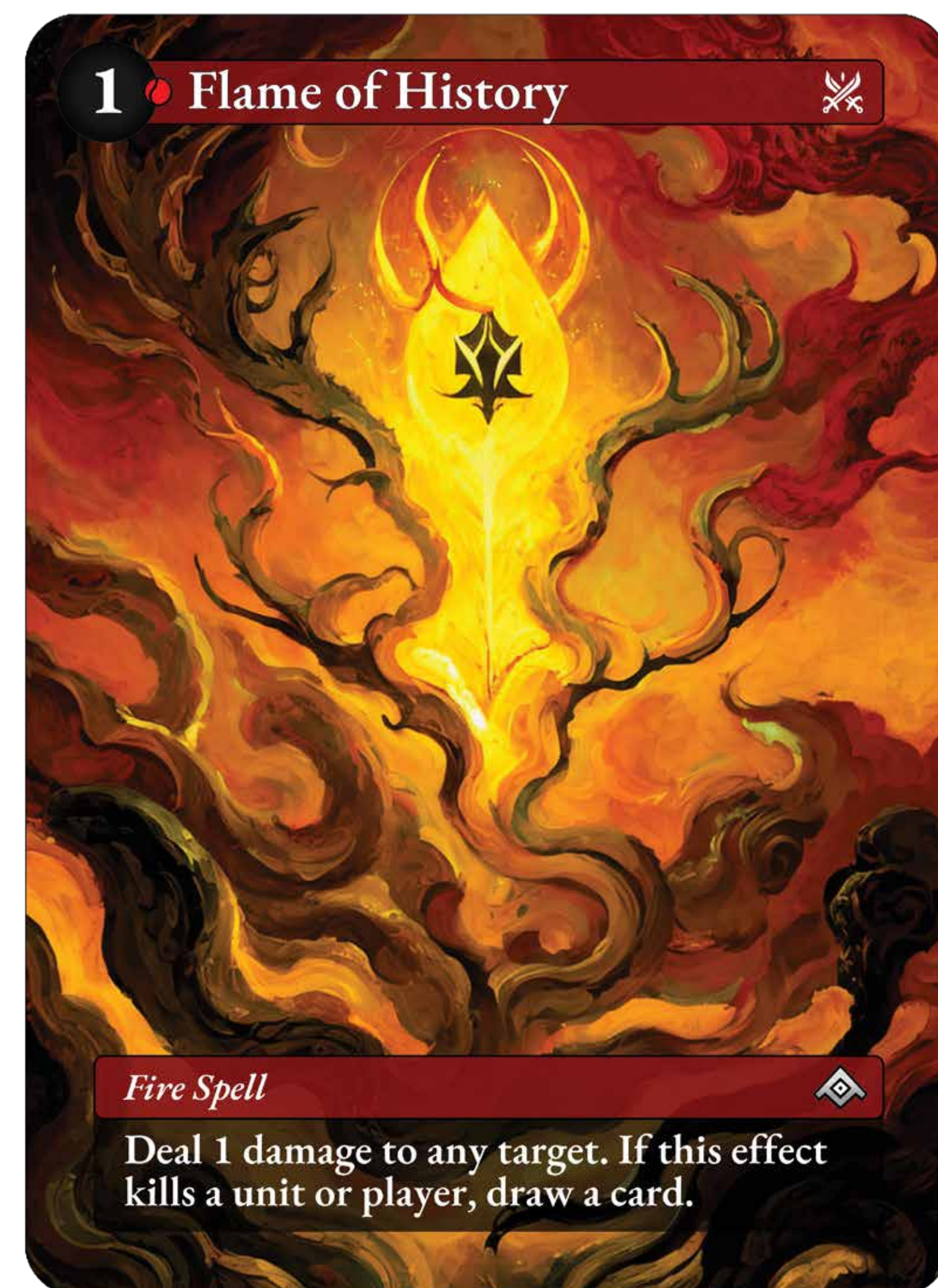
- If player A passes priority and player B passes priority, the phase ends and we move directly to the block/counterattack step. Notice how you cannot respond to an opponent passing priority. Once you pass, you may not get another chance to act.
- If player A passes priority and player B casts a spell, Player A will receive priority again.
- If player A casts a spell and player B passes priority, player A's spell will resolve, creating another priority window.
- If player A casts a spell, and player B responds with a spell, player A will receive priority again to react to player B's spell.



The Stack

First in, Last Out

All interaction in Algomancy uses the stack, which abides by the concept of “First in, last out”. Visually you can see this by placing any new effects on top of any other existing effects on the stack. Then when its time to resolve a spell, you resolve them in order from top to bottom. Whatever spell or effect happened last will resolve first. Look at the example below.



I play Flame of history. My opponent has a chance to respond.



They respond to Flame of History with Boon of Protection, putting it on top of the stack.



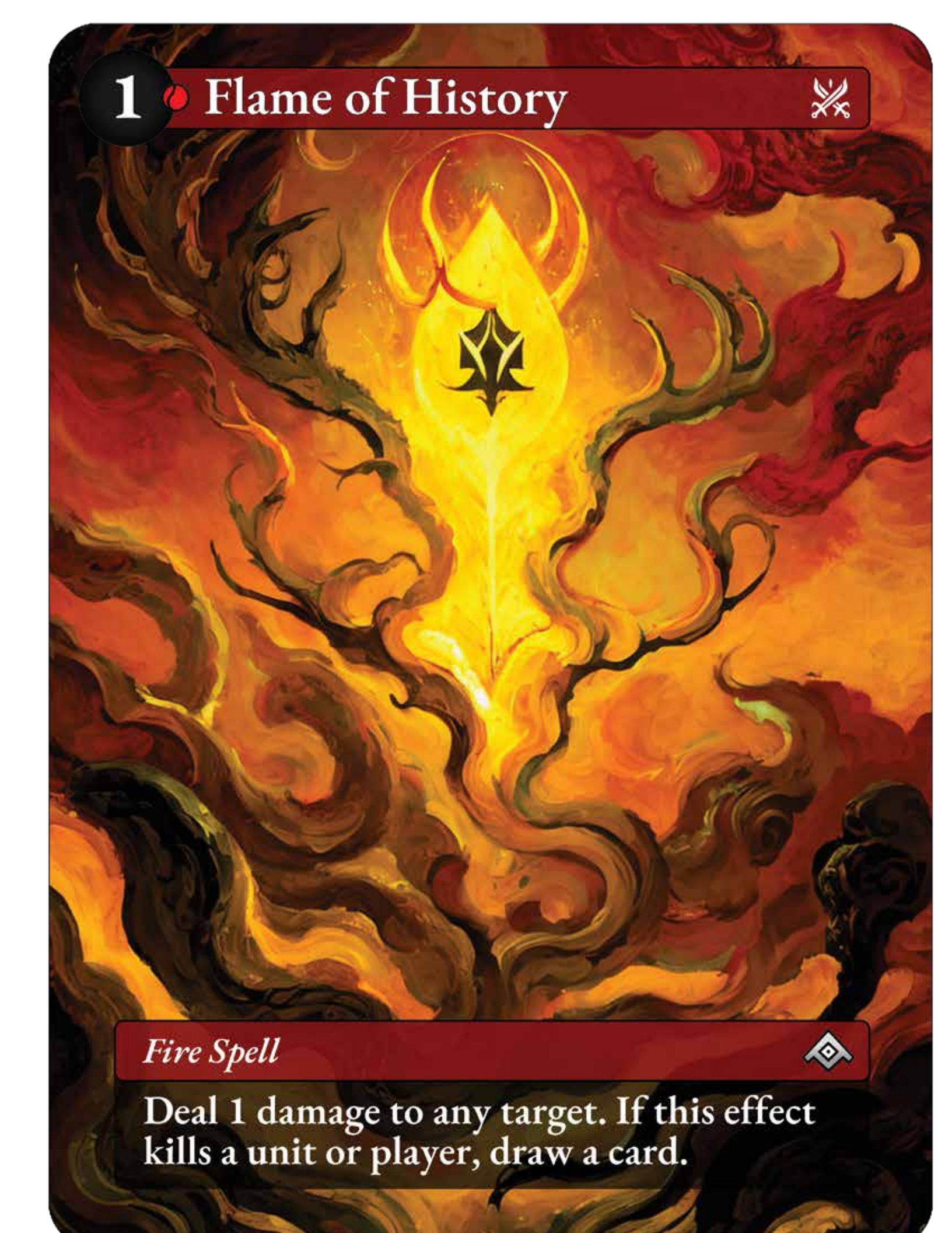
I respond to Boon of Protection with Arc Lightning, putting it on top of the stack.



All players pass priority. Arc Lightning resolves first, because it was on top of the stack.



New spells can be added on top of an active stack even after it has started resolving. I cast Null Drone targeting Boon of Protection.



Null Drone resolves first as the top card of the stack, negating Boon of Protection. If both players pass priority, finally, Flame of History can

Modifications

Augment

Some cards have a little “+” symbol (1) at the beginning of a line in their text box (or type line). This symbol denotes the Augment mechanic, which allows you to take all of the text in the paragraph following the augment symbol and add it onto other cards. For example, Big Flower has the augmentable effect “I gain +1/+1 for each other ally.”

To apply an Augment, you must meet its threshold requirements. Then you pay its mana cost and select a target to apply the augment onto. Place your augment card beneath the targeted card, with the textbox visible beneath it to demonstrate the additional line of text. **You may augment cards onto any legal target and can apply augments both from your hand and from your discard.** Typically, Augment can only be done during the main phase so you can only augment onto your own units (unless the card is a virus, more on that later).

There is no restriction on the number of times a card can be augmented, so go wild!



1

This token has been augmented with the ranged attribute as well as the ability from Big Flower.



Control and Language

When a card is modified, it is simply treated as if it were a single card with all of the additional text from its modifications. The augmented cards are not separate from the base card.

This means that if you augment a card onto an opponent's unit, they control that modification and all of that text applies to their card as if it were their own.

Permadeath

When a modified card dies or is erased (both Augment and Graft, which we will discuss next, are modifications), the card and all of its modifications are erased (permanently removed from the game). So choose carefully when and how you use your modifications because they can be lost forever!

If a modified card would leave play but did not die or get erased (for example, if it was put into your hand from play), all of its modifications are put back into the discard.

Graft

The second modification in Algomancy is Graft, which is denoted by the two arrows in a hexagon shape (1). All graft cards follow the template of “Cause ->(Graft) Effect”. In the example of Sprouter, the cause is “Sacrifice me” and the effect is “Create a Poison 1”. What the graft mechanic does, is allow you to add additional effects onto a cause. Then the resulting card is read as “Cause -> Effect1 AND Effect2 AND Effect3...etc”. There is no limit to how many effects can be grafted onto a single card. The resulting ability is treated as a single ability, so it will all resolve at once, from top to bottom, and the entire thing can be countered by a single spell.

In the example on the right, we have grafted the card Overbloom onto sprouter. Now sprouter reads “Sacrifice me: Create a Poison 1 AND (once per turn) Target unit gains +7/+7 until regroup.” The small 1 inside of the graft symbol of Overbloom (2) is called a limited graft, which means that ability only triggers once per turn. Additionally, if the cause of a card is limited, as in Moosh below, the entire graft effect is limited to trigger that number of times. So even though “Create a Poison 1” is an unbounded graft, this grafted ability will only trigger when it sees the first enemy die. It reads as “Whenever an enemy dies (once per turn), Create a 2/2 unit AND Create a Poison 1.”



Applying a graft follows the same cost and timing setup as augments (play from hand or discard during the main phase, pay the card’s cost and meet threshold requirements in order to do so), with the additional requirement that both cards must have the graft symbol in order to be able to apply a graft. To put it another way, you can’t simply graft an effect onto a non graft card, because there is no cause to trigger that effect. Grafts can only go onto other graft cards.

Grafted effects are read from top to bottom in order, so when applying a new graft, you may insert the new effect at any position within the graft stack below the original card, but you may not re-order the rest of the grafted abilities.

If you have an unbounded graft cause and a mixture of bounded and unbounded effects, the graft cause will trigger an unlimited number of times, but each of the bounded effects will only trigger a limited number of times.

If you have a bounded graft cause, the entire effect will only trigger a limited number of times.